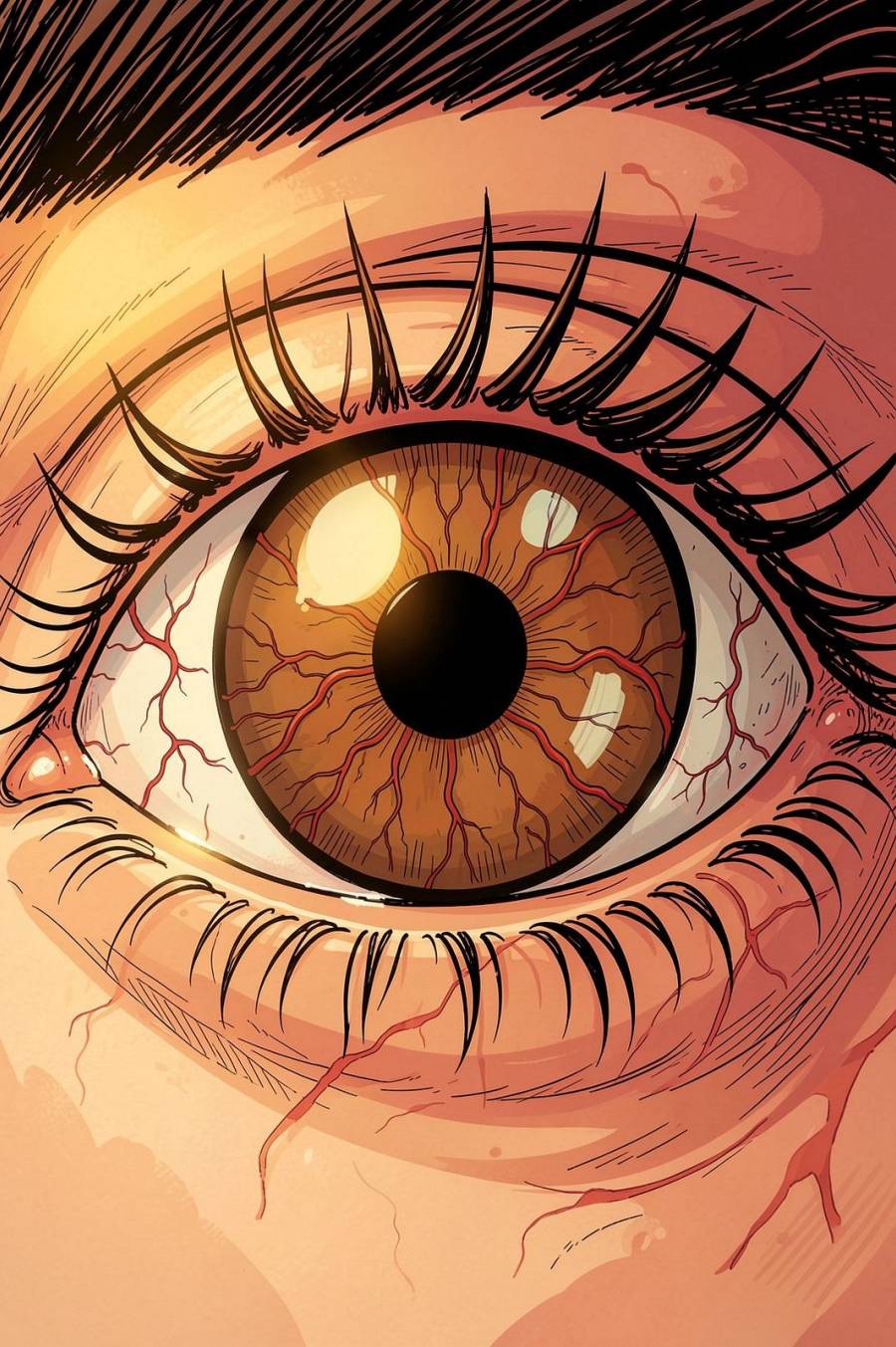




Hypertension and Eye Health

Can high blood pressure affect your vision? Most people think about the heart, brain, or kidneys — but your eyes are at risk too.

What Is Hypertension?

Hypertension (high blood pressure) occurs when pressure against your blood vessel walls stays too high over time.

The "Silent" Condition

High blood pressure often develops without obvious symptoms — making regular checks essential, even when you feel well.

Why It Matters

Long-term elevated pressure can damage small blood vessels throughout the body — including those in your eyes.



How High Blood Pressure Affects Your Eyes



Hypertensive Retinopathy

The retina contains a network of small blood vessels. Long-term high blood pressure can cause these vessels to narrow, bleed, or swell — a condition called **hypertensive retinopathy**.

Vessel Narrowing

Bleeding & Swelling

Optic Nerve Damage

Can High Blood Pressure Cause Blurred Vision?

It **can** — but blurred vision doesn't automatically mean hypertension is the cause. Many eye conditions can cause blurry vision.



Silent Changes

Some people with high blood pressure have eye changes with **no noticeable symptoms** — making regular exams critical.



Don't Self-Diagnose

If you notice vision changes, have your eyes properly examined rather than assuming the problem will resolve on its own.



What Can an Eye Examination Detect?

A comprehensive eye exam lets your eye-care professional examine the retina, optic nerve, and blood vessels inside the eye.

1

Dilated Examination

Reveals changes in retinal blood vessels associated with high blood pressure and other conditions.

2

Vascular Health Clues

The eyes can provide important information about the health of blood vessels throughout the body.

3

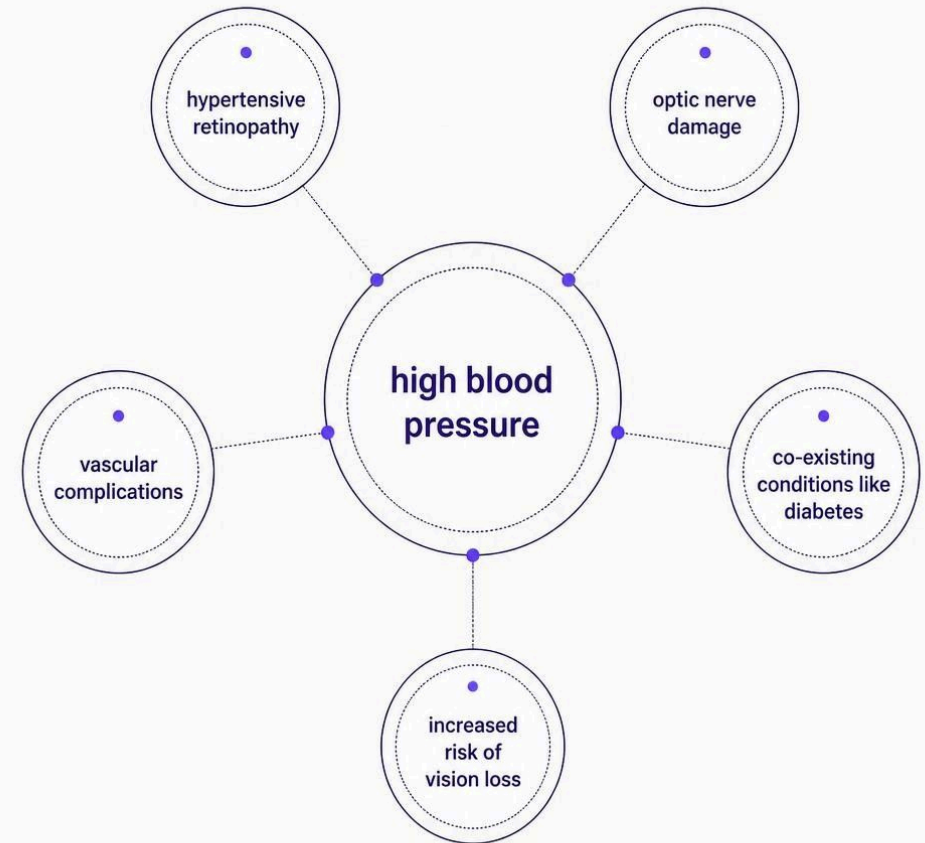
Not a Replacement

An eye exam cannot replace blood-pressure monitoring — but it adds valuable insight.

High Blood Pressure & Other Eye Conditions

High blood pressure can be associated with several eye problems and can increase the risk of certain vascular complications. It may also occur alongside other conditions, such as diabetes, that can affect the eyes.

📄 **National Eye Institute recommendation:** Many people with high blood pressure need a dilated eye examination **at least once a year**. Discuss the right frequency with your doctor.



How to Protect Your Eyes

Taking care of your blood pressure is part of taking care of your eyes.

01

Monitor & Treat

Check blood pressure regularly and take prescribed medication as directed.

03

See Your Eye Doctor

Attend regular eye exams and tell your eye-care professional about your hypertension diagnosis.

02

Attend Appointments

Follow your healthcare professional's advice on diet, physical activity, and medical visits.

04

Report Changes

Report any significant or sudden changes in your vision promptly.

When to Seek Urgent Help

Sudden vision loss, severe eye pain, or major sudden changes in vision should **never be ignored**.



Vision Symptoms

Sudden vision loss, severe eye pain, or major sudden vision changes.

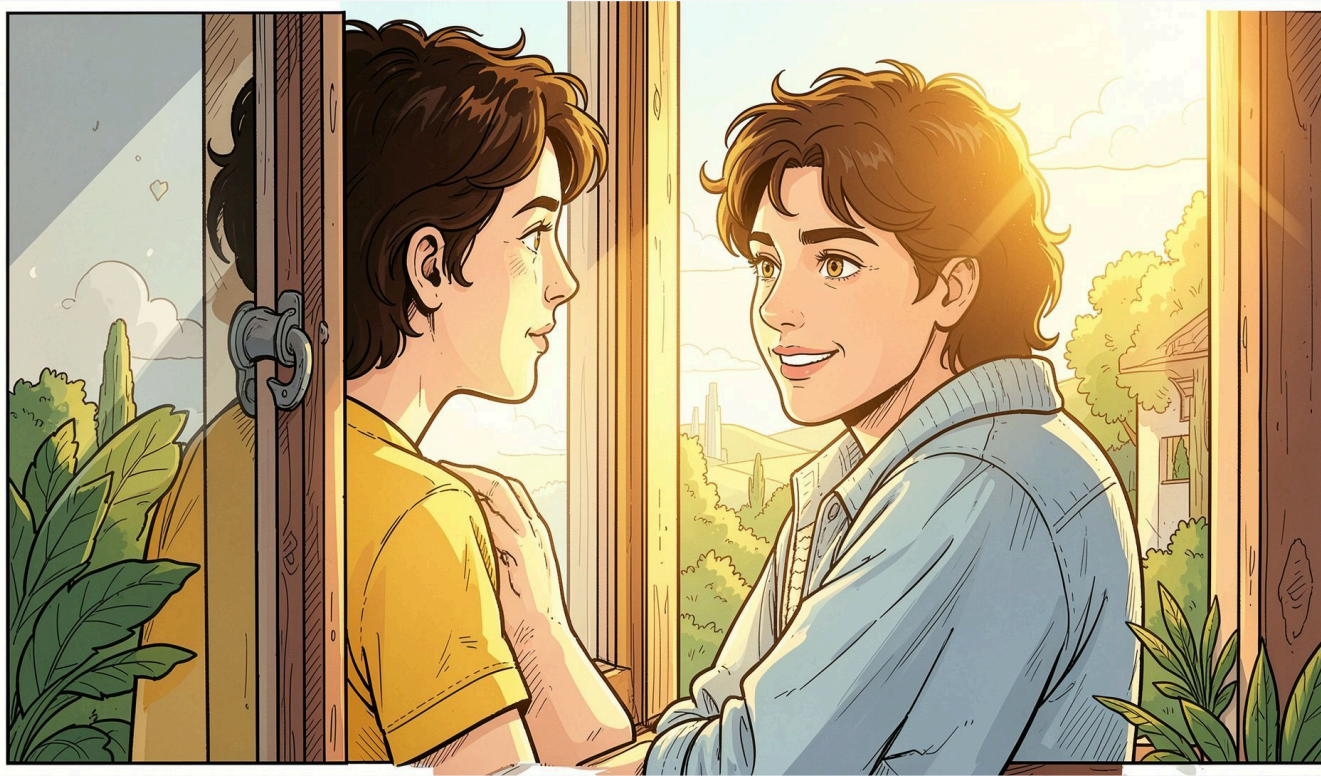


Systemic Symptoms

Very high blood pressure with severe headache, chest pain, difficulty breathing, or neurological symptoms.



Your Blood Pressure and Your Eyes Are Connected



Your eyes are not separate from the rest of your body. Conditions affecting your blood vessels and general health can also affect your vision.

If you have hypertension, don't only monitor your blood pressure — **remember your eyes too.**

Regular medical care, good blood-pressure management, and appropriate eye examinations all play an important role in protecting your sight.

Your Vision Is Worth Protecting

If you have high blood pressure, diabetes, a family history of eye disease, or concerns about your vision, consider scheduling a comprehensive eye examination.

Akafo Eye Services

Comprehensive eye examinations for patients with hypertension and other health conditions.

Schedule Today

Don't wait for symptoms. Regular exams can detect changes before they affect your vision.

This content is for general educational purposes and does not replace medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment from a qualified healthcare professional.

